The World Is Her Canvas

PERSISTENCE AND PERSEVERANCE best describe art curator Masooma Rizvi. She doesn't believe in taking no for an answer. Her decisions may seem too bold to many, but that's only because she believes that nothing is impossible and lives by the mantra that if something doesn't work out, there is always a plan B.

It's because of this outlook that Masooma is behind some of the most talked about and appreciated public projects in the country today. The prestigious list includes the 'India Corridor' at the new Parliament building in New Delhi, a Rashtrapati Bhavan project during President A.P.J. Abdul Kalam's tenure, the Manekshaw Centre and the Sushma Swaraj Bhawan, and Jaipur's Amar Jawan Jyoti memorial park.

A proponent of 'vocal for local', Masooma began her art odyssey 22 years ago and has always strived to make spaces and buildings functional and place them in the context of their climate and surroundings. Even as a child, she took a keen interest in beautifying spaces in Hyderabad, going on to study architecture in the US and obtain a master's degree and a Ph.D. in fine arts conservation. "I want to conserve wall paintings as I truly believe that's the story of our past and our future," she says.

Masooma feels that her multi-faith and multi-cultural family background, where all festivals are celebrated irrespective of religion, has helped her evolve into the person she is today. Her husband, who retired from the army, and two children—a son and a daughter—have been a constant source of strength.

Not one to compromise or take shortcuts, Massomasays, "At the end of the day, when you sleep, you are happy with what you did. So, why live a life of compromises?" ■ ***–Shelly Anand***

ACCOMPLISHMENT
In her 22-year-long career, Masooma has helmed several public art projects showcasing India's rich heritage and culture

GRANDMA'S ADVICE

"My maternal grandmother taught me that if you want something and it's right, it will come to you. So, don't give up"

WAY OF LIVING "Live by your own moral compass and don't be affected by what people say"



Masooma Rizvi, *55*
Art Curator

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH